Silver Tanka introduced by Iltutmish, Ala-ud-din Khalji's gold coins, Muhammad-bin-Tughluq's copper *token currency* are indicative of coinage as well as the economic prosperity or otherwise of the country of the time.

DO YOU KNOW?

A jital contained 3.6 grains of silver. Forty-eight jitals were equal to 1 silver tanka.



## Religious Literature

Devotional movement in South India and later in North resulted in the development of bhakti or devotional literature. The Chola period was known as the period of devotional literature and works such as *Kamba Ramayanam,* Sekkizhar's *Periyapuranam, Nalayira Divyaprabhandham,* composed by 12 Azhwars and compiled by Nathamuni, *Devaram* composed by Appar, Sambandar and Sundarar and compiled by Nambiyandar Nambi, Manikkavasakar's *Thiruvasagam,* all were scripted during the Chola times. Jayadeva's *Gita Govindam* (12th century) was a follow-up of the Bhakti Movement in South India. Kabir Das, a 15th century mystic poet, also had an influence on the Bhakti Movement in India.

## Secular Literature

*Madura Vijayam* and *Amuktamalyatha* were poems composed by Gangadevi and Krishnadevaraya respectively that help us gain insight into the events and individuals associated with the Vijayanagara Empire. Chand Bardai's *Prithiviraj Raso* portrays the Rajput king's valour. For pre-Islamic periods, the only exception was Kalhana's *Rajtarangini* (11th century).

## Books, Biographies and Autobiographies

Minhaj-us-Siraj, patronised by Sultan Nazir-ud-din Mahmud of Slave Dynasty, wrote *Tabakat-i-Nasiri*. The compendium deals with the period from the conquest of Muhammad Ghori to A.D. (CE) 1260. The compendium was named after his patron. In the 13th century, Hasan Nizami, a migrant from Ghazni wrote. *Taj-ul-Ma'asir* towards the end of Iltutmish's rule. It provides information about Qutb-ud-din Aibak and is considered the first official history of the Delhi Sultanate. Zia-ud-din Barani, a courtier of Muhammad Tughluq, wrote *Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi,* in which he dealt with the history of Delhi Sultanate from Ghiyas-ud-din Balban to the early years of the reign of Firoz Shah Tughluq. Ferishta's *Tarikh-i-Frishta* (16th century) deals with the history of the rise of the Mughal power in India.

***Tabakat*** is an Arabic word meaning 'generations or centuries'.
***Tuzk*** is a Persian word meaning 'autobiography'.
***Tarikh*** or ***Tahquiq*** are Arabic words meaning 'history'.

In the 16th century, emperor Babur's *Babur Nama* and Abul Fazal's *Ain-i-Akbari* and Akbar Nama provided detailed information about these two emperors. In the 17th century, Jahangir wrote his memoir, *Tuzk-i-Jahangiri,* throwing a lot of light on the period. Apart from autobiographies of emperors, *Tabakat-i-Akbari,* authored by Nizam-ud-din Ahmad, is considered reliable than the exaggerated account



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